

Highlights

An Exact Decomposition of Paired Score Differences by Relabelling Within Groups

- Exact identity splits a paired score gain by relabelling cases within groups
- The remainder is a within-group forecast-outcome covariance, not classical resolution
- Cluster-robust inference, a CLT, and reduction to a clustered Diebold-Mariano test
- Only the covariance part of a reported gain survives a shift in label frequencies
- A released debiasing method's proper-score gain is almost all transported